

Cuban Chicken Empanadas with Crispy Plantains

Total Time: 45-55 minutes Calories per Serving: 800

Serves: 2 people

Empanada means "to bake in pastry" in Spanish. It is a turnover with a pastry crust that is traditionally filled with meat or vegetables. This Cuban-inspired version is filled with grape tomato and roasted chicken.



1. Prepare Ingredients

Preheat oven to 400°F. Rinse **tomatoes**, then cut a small slit in each, about ¼ way through. Peel **onion** and mince. Mince **garlic**. Peel **plantains** and cut on a diagonal into ½-inch slices. Pat **chicken** dry with paper towel. Using 2 forks or tongs, shred into large pieces, discarding bones.



2. Make Filling

Heat **1 tablespoon olive oil** in a large pan over medium heat. When oil is shimmering, add **spice mix** and **onion** and sauté until softened, 4 minutes. Add **tomatoes** and **garlic** and sauté, breaking up with a spoon, until tomatoes are softened and their juices release, about 6 minutes. Remove from heat and transfer to a large bowl. Taste and add **salt** and **pepper** as needed. Stir in **Monterey Jack** and **chicken**.



3. Assemble Empanadas

Arrange **empanada dough** in a single layer on a parchment-lined baking sheet. Add **filling** to 1 side of each piece, dividing evenly. Fold dough, carefully stretching over filling, and seal edges tightly using the tines of a fork (see Recipe Tip).



4. Bake Empanadas

Cut a small slit on top of each **empanada** for steam to escape. Transfer to oven and bake until puffed and golden, about 18 minutes.



5. Fry Plantains

When empanadas are about halfway roasted, wipe pan from filling clean and add **3 tablespoons canola oil** over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **plantains** in a single layer and fry, working in batches if necessary, until browned and crisp, 3-4 minutes per side (see Recipe Tip). Transfer to a paper towel-lined plate to drain and immediately season with **salt**.



6. Plate Empanadas

Divide **empanadas** evenly between 2 plates and serve with **plantains** alongside.

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RECIPE TIPS

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking. Trust us—you'll be glad you did!

Empanada dough becomes pliable as it warms and softens slightly. Once tempered, you can gently stretch it over your filling to seal.

Be sure not to crowd plantains in the pan or they'll steam and become soft instead of crispy.

INGREDIENTS

- 3 ounces grape tomatoes
- 1 yellow onion
- 2 cloves garlic
- 2 plantains
- 1 roasted half chicken
- 1 spice mix
  - 1 teaspoon ground cumin
  - 1 teaspoon sweet paprika
  - 1 teaspoon dried thyme
- 3 ounces shredded Monterey Jack cheese
- 6 pieces empanada dough
- 1 parchment paper

YOU'LL NEED

- 12" large pan
- baking sheet
- 1 tablespoon olive oil
- 3 tablespoons canola oil
- kosher salt
- black pepper

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